

Bulent Keles

15+ years of experience in digital design, product strategy, and leadership. Championed user-centric solutions for tech startups and Fortune 500 companies, leading design teams and driving innovation through emerging technologies.

bulentkeles.com bulentkeles@gmail.com +90 (553) 204 8608 +974 7061 7366

Experiences

01

QNB
SVP, DIGITAL CENTER OF EXCELLENCE

DOHA, QATAR
2025 — PRESENT

QNB is one of the largest financial institutions in the Middle East, Europe, and Africa, providing comprehensive banking services across retail, corporate, and international markets.

DIGITAL BANKING · FINTECH · RETAIL · CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE · DESIGN SYSTEMS · AI BANKING

- Lead the Digital Center of Excellence, shaping digital experience strategy and design standards for all digital products.
- Lead the redesign of the QNB mobile banking app and development of a scalable enterprise Design System.
- Shape QNB's digital banking vision across channels and markets.
- Established design standards to drive consistency across products.
- Partnered with Digital, Technology, Product, Marketing, Brand, and business teams to deliver customer-centric experiences.
- Drove UX research, testing, and continuous experience improvement.
- Mentored design teams, strengthening UX maturity and culture.
- Explored with AI to shape next-generation banking experiences.
- Influenced digital strategy through customer insights, market benchmarking, and competitive analysis.

02

ACCENTURE
DESIGN MANAGER

ISTANBUL, TURKEY
2019 — 2025

Accenture is a global professional services company providing a broad range of services in strategy, consulting, digital, technology, and operations.

AUTOMOTIVE · ENERGY · E-COMMERCE · GOVERNMENT · SAAS · LIFE-SCIENCES · TECHNOLOGY

- Led design at Accenture Turkey, delivering next-generation digital products for global clients.
- Managed and mentored team of designers, setting vision, standards, and ways of working.
- Designed user-centered web, mobile and other experiences across multiple industries.
- Led user research and usability testing to improve product experiences.
- Developed wireframes, prototypes, and mockups, collaborating with engineers for effective implementation.
- Established agile design practices and design standards for the team.
- Presented design concepts to clients and supported new business development.
- Explored GenAI applications, bringing emerging technologies to client solutions and presented future of products to clients.

03

SELF-EMPLOYED
FREELANCE DESIGNER

SAN FRANCISCO, REMOTE
2017 — 2021

As a self-employed designer, I provided services to Silicon Valley startups, focusing on creating impactful and user-friendly products.

SPORTS · PUBLISHING · REAL ESTATE · RETAIL

- Designed mobile apps, web apps, marketing sites, presentations, logos, book covers, landing pages, and email templates for Silicon Valley startups.
- Conducted usability tests and created user personas to ensure effective design solutions.
- Developed advanced wireframes, prototypes, and visual design guidelines.
- Researched product requirements, tested product-market fit, and presented to product teams.
- Communicated effectively with engineers and clients to deliver high-end graphics and interactions.

04

KOLEKTIF LABS
PRODUCT DESIGNER & CONSULTANT

ISTANBUL, TURKEY
2017 — 2017

Kolektif Labs is a design agency delivering innovative products and solutions across various industries.

FINANCE & TRADING · SPORTS · RETAIL · SAAS

- Collaborated closely with client teams and developers in an agile workflow to deliver user-centered designs across sports, finance, and technology industries.
- Created and presented concepts, wireframes, and prototypes for user testing and client feedback, ensuring design decisions were informed and efficient.
- Developed and communicated design processes, streamlining collaboration with clients and developers.

05

INNOVATION BOX
UI/UX DESIGNER & CONSULTANT

SAN FRANCISCO, REMOTE
2016 — 2016

InnovationBox is a design studio focusing on delivering high-quality mobile products as well as web applications.

SAAS · B2C · VENTURE CAPITAL · EVENT MANAGEMENT · UTILITY

- Established design standards and collaborated with client teams to understand their needs, ensuring successful web application projects.
- Created wireframes, prototypes, and proof-of-concepts (POCs) to communicate design ideas and functionality for web applications.
- Prepared RFPs and supported sales with compelling client presentations, contributing to securing new design projects.

06

VALENSAS TECHNOLOGY
HEAD OF PRODUCTS

ISTANBUL, TURKEY
2012 — 2016

Valensas is an enterprise mobility and product development company, dedicated to creating innovative solutions and delivering top-quality software for its clients.

DIGITAL BANKING · PUBLISHING · PAAS · AVIATION

- Led product design and marketing for mobility products, driving product-market fit through research, data, and customer insights.
- Defined product vision and roadmap, translating customer needs into new product concepts and experiences.
- Built product prototypes and concepts to showcase opportunities and support new business development.
- Led product demos, launches, and investor pitches, communicating product vision and business value.
- Identified customer friction points and partnered with product and engineering teams to improve experiences.

07	**GREY WORLDWIDE** DIGITAL MARKETING MANAGER	**ISTANBUL, TURKEY** 2010 — 2012
	Famed for its effectiveness since 1917, WPP-owned Grey ranks among the top advertising and marketing organizations globally. AUTOMOTIVE · FMCG · BANKING · AVIATION	• Crafted data-driven plans and delivered successful online marketing initiatives across various channels (social media, content marketing, etc.). • Brought marketing visions to life through design and effectively presented information to diverse audiences. • Identified opportunities and informed strategic decisions by analyzing market trends and social media performance. • Built and nurtured brand communities online through engaging content creation and management.
08	**FEZA MEDIA** MARKETING & BRAND MANAGER	**ISTANBUL, TURKEY** 2004 — 2009
	A defunct but formerly leading media group with over a million subscribers and an advanced digital publishing presence. MEDIA · PUBLISHING · ADVERTISING · BRANDS · MARKETING · DIGITAL MARKETING · DIGITAL MEDIA	• Advanced from trainee to Marketing Manager in a prominent media company, gaining firsthand experience in brand management, audience engagement, and customer-centric communications. • Directed integrated marketing initiatives in collaboration with global creative agencies such as Ogilvy, ensuring consistent and impactful brand expression across digital and traditional channels. • Orchestrated international brand activations at global publishing fairs and industry trade shows—developing event strategies, content, and sponsorships that elevated brand visibility. • This period marked the beginning of a user-centered mindset and channel orchestration that would evolve into full-spectrum digital product design and omnichannel experience strategy.
09	**CITY OF ISTANBUL** SYSTEMS & NETWORK ADMIN	**ISTANBUL, TURKEY** 2001 — 2004
	The largest metropolitan municipality in Türkiye, responsible for delivering essential public services to over 16 million residents through complex, city-wide digital and physical infrastructure. GOVERNMENT SERVICES · NETWORK SYSTEMS · INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY	• Led the end-to-end administration of critical IT infrastructure for the Istanbul Metropolitan Municipality, supporting thousands of internal users across diverse departments. • Oversaw the maintenance, performance, and security of all application, database, and messaging servers—laying a technical foundation that informed later user-centric digital initiatives. • Developed a systems-level understanding of enterprise architecture, which continues to shape a holistic approach to digital service design and operational excellence.

Boston University

MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEMS, 2004

Concentrated in Information Systems, a program focused on understanding and using data systems to assists the decision making process in modern business environments.

General Assembly

UX IMMERSIVE PROGRAM, 2016

Completed an intensive UX program and deepened my understanding of user-centric design. Gained proficiency in prototyping for agile development in today's workplaces.

Skills & Tools

UI Design • UX Design • Interaction Design • User Research • Graphic Design • Animation • Mobile App Design • Web Design • Digital Signage • Responsive Design • Accessibility Design • Wireframing • Prototyping • Design Systems • Journey Mapping • Usability Testing • Heuristic Analysis • Presentation Design • Material Design • Carbon Design • Fluent Design • Liquid Oxygen • Brand Identity • Logo Design • Figma • Sketch • Framer • GenAI • Zeplin • Grids • Illustrator • Premier • Photoshop • Indesign • HTML • CSS • Atom • GitHub • Sublime • Visual Studio Code • Jira • Azure DevOps • Trello • Slack • Apple HIG • Analytics • HotJar • Mixpanel • ChatGPT • Lovable • Claude • Gemini • Suno • DeepSeek

Languages

I'm native in Turkish, fluent in English and working on my German skills.